

CHAPTER

4

GETTING STARTED

Use Your Scale Wisely

Keeep one thing in mind: bodyweight can be deceptive. Looking—and feeling—great is not about the number on your scale.

When you're following my program, you engage in both weightlifting and aerobic exercise. You will increase muscle density, but not necessarily muscle size, unless you lift weights in a way designed to build muscle mass. Some female clients worry about getting too big, but I promise you that just does not happen. One pound of muscle takes up about half the space compared to a pound of fat. So, it is entirely possible for your bodyweight to increase after gaining muscle, while your waist size decreases significantly.

Don't freak out if your bodyweight increases. Don't worry about the number on your scale. The goal is to change your body, not a number. The tools to chart your progress are a mirror and how your clothes fit. And, of course, how you feel.

In collaboration with BuzzFeed, I shot a video called “We lost 22% of Bodyfat in 6 Weeks.” (<https://youtu.be/TNQ8ZKq9QQ0>). During this process, producer Ashley Perez gained 4 pounds on the scale but she dropped two dress sizes in six weeks, and went from 24% bodyfat down to 18%. That means she lost 25% of her bodyfat! That's a huge change.

She began at 136 pounds and ended at 140 pounds. But in the process she dropped 8 pounds of fat. Ashley told me this is the best she has ever looked, and now she's incredibly comfortable in her own skin.

That's the goal.

Think of your muscles as a 12-cylinder gas guzzling Ferrari—the more muscle fibers you have, the more calories your body will burn every day, even at rest. If you have a small amount of muscle fibers then your body will function more like a moped—performing more with far less fuel. A moped person can eat the same thing as a Ferrari person, but they will end up storing the excess as fat for later use because they lack the muscle to burn it off.

SUPERHERO STORY: Reboot Your Body

★ Zach Dresler trained with me for six weeks for the “We Lost 22% of Bodyfat in 6 Weeks” video, and he lost 30.1 pounds of bodyfat. Of course, he also added muscle mass.

“Steve Zim taught me what I need to eat and how to train,” Zach says. “It was a hard-line crash course, but he rebooted my body.”

While we finished up our six-week program a couple years ago, Zach still trains at my gym in Culver City.

“Sometimes I ask Steve for tips on form or questions about nutrition, but he taught me how to take charge of my own program.” Zach keeps his nutrition clean to this day. “I add in a cheat meal one day a week or so because now that I have my engine going, I can maintain the fat loss and have a few more cheat meals here and there.”

Zach adds a word of encouragement for others who are just starting out: “It may sound overwhelming at first, but when you simplify Steve’s program and follow it consistently for 2-3 months, you’ll not only improve the way you look, but you’ll increase your chances for a longer life.”

in mind that the number on the scale to measure “progress” must be redefined.

First of all... let’s be realistic. Do you truly care how much you weigh on a scale or would you rather be the same size you were when you were happiest with your body? Have you spent your whole life trying to get to the point where you say, “Sure I’ll put on a bathing suit and go to the beach with my friends?” If you were five pounds heavier than you are today but were three sizes smaller, would you complain?

Thinking of yourself as a top-of-the-line Ferrari is a confidence builder. Millions of people spend hours every year buying self-help books and finding ways to achieve happiness. Gaining the physical self-confidence that Ashley achieved in six weeks can go a long way to improving all areas of your life. If you don’t love your body, achieving other goals that make you happy are more difficult. Let’s fix it together.

Here’s what you need to get started.

PUT YOUR SCALE IN PERSPECTIVE

Because weight loss and weight gain are emotionally charged issues for many people, it’s important that you don’t get hung up on body-weight numbers. Your actual weight can be deceptive. Keep

Unless you have to make weight for a boxing or wrestling match, bodyweight alone is irrelevant. Bodyweight is only one aspect of four that tells the full story of what is going on with your body:

- 1) **Scale and bodyweight**
- 2) **Physical measurements (hips, waist, etc.)**
- 3) **Bodyfat test**
- 4) **Before and after photos**

By keeping track of these four distinct metrics, you get a much clearer picture of what is happening in your body. It's how you know if you're changing in the right way. These measurements are available and accessible to everyone and can accurately determine the amount of muscle, bone density, and fat you gain and lose. Let me go through each of them:

BODYWEIGHT

When you step onto a scale, you are weighing muscle, fat and other important bodyparts, including water, hair, organs and bone. But clearly, you shouldn't care how much your hair, organs and bones weigh. These, essentially, aren't things you can change to improve your health and appearance.

When you rely only on your scale it's much harder to maintain your new set point than it is to reach it. When most people lose a large amount of scale weight, they also lose much needed muscle mass and water. They reduce the power of the engine that burns the fat. And the greater the loss of muscle tissue, the harder it is for you to maintain weight loss over the long term. So don't use scale weight, especially alone, as a measure of your success.

BODYPART MEASUREMENTS

Take your measurements before you begin your nutrition program. When you have your measurements taken, it is important to do so prior to exercise. Don't take them after you lift or do cardio because they won't be accurate. Knowing your measurements is crucial for several reasons.

First, accurate measurements give you a sense of your body's symmetry. As your body transforms over the course of the program, these initial measurements help to determine which parts of your body need more or less work.

For instance, some of my male clients often notice a sudden appearance of love handles upon progressing through my program. So, what is going on? Using a tape measure, I show them they actually lost a few inches around their waist, but many more inches around their trunk. In one specific case, upon measuring the area surrounding the belly button, my client had lost three inches despite his newly visible “love handles.”

We can't choose from which part of our bodies we shed fat first. Our bodies do that for us. Muscle, on the other hand, can be gained or lost in targeted areas of the body depending on your exercise regimen, but that's a more detailed discussion for my next book. For every person, there are areas that shed fat more easily than others. Once you've burned fat from those easier areas, your body will intuitively begin targeting the fat located in the more reluctant areas. At that point, your progress will be apparent on a near daily basis.

BODYFAT PERCENTAGE

Measuring your bodyfat percentage is an essential step in assessing your physical status, both when you start and to track your progress. There are a variety of methods used to perform this measurement, ranging in price from free to \$15 to \$15,000. The most accurate bodyfat test is the water submersion test, but if it's not readily available and affordable, then many gyms have a skinfold or scale bodyfat test available, or else they can refer you to someone who can perform this test.

Calipers typically measure the fat content beneath the skin from three to five different parts of your body. Then, using both your scale weight and fat content, they calculate your bodyfat percentage. Often, you can have this measurement taken at the gym, by a licensed nutritionist, an accredited personal trainer, or by a general practitioner. This test can cost anywhere from \$15 to \$35 dollars, but its results are invaluable.

After this measurement is taken, you will know exactly how much of your total weight is comprised of fat, and how much is muscle. Instead of stepping on the scale every day to check your progress, have your bodyfat percentage measured every two weeks or so. Learning the ratios of fat to lean muscle mass is vital information that can truly change your perspective when addressing the sensitive topic of weight.

Bodyfat percentage standards differ by gender. An excellent bodyfat percentage for a man is 12% or somewhat lower, while for a woman it is 18% or somewhat lower. For reference, most competitive male athletes hover between 6-13% bodyfat; female athletes compete between 14-20 % bodyfat. Male bodybuilders compete at about 2-4 % on contest days, and female bodybuilders at about 4-6%.

It is VERY important to note that the moment a competition is over, bodybuilders resume their normal eating habits. By the next day, they will not look anything like they did on stage hours earlier. Many professional bodybuilders will gain twenty or more pounds during their off-season, enabling them to build more mass, from which they can later burn fat, resulting in an even larger percentage of lean muscle mass the next season. That's a bit of a tangent, but it's important, for realistic expectations, to know bodybuilders do not look competitively lean all of the time.

KEEP A VISUAL DIARY

On Day 1 take a front and back photo of yourself. Side photos are optional. Have a friend take the photos from about 10 feet away. Try to find a place where the light is even—in other words don't take a photo near a window or where there is a spotlight to one side. That can lead to a picture that makes you look uneven. One side could look flat while the other looks more cut.



For each pose, you should take two photos—one where you are relaxed and the other where you are flexing. This will allow you to see the changes in your appearance both ways—the posed one will help show increases in muscle mass as

well as increased detail as you shed bodyfat.

SUPERHERO WORKOUT: Hit the Books!

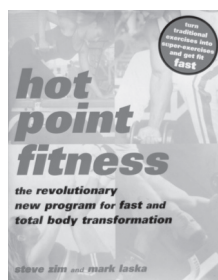
★ Working out with weights at least three days a week is essential to getting you to the Superhero body you're striving for. My next project is a fitness book titled *Superhero Workout*. But until that book comes out I'd like you to take a look at one of my previous books. I've already published three bestselling fitness books with workouts, and I believe they are still the best on the market today. What are out of date in these books are the nutrition and cardio sections, which is why I'm writing this book.

I recommend that you take pictures once a week—you don't want to do it too frequently because you won't see as much progress. But you don't want the interval to be too long either because you won't have as clear of a record of your fat loss.

Make sure you wear the same clothes every time and shoot the photos in the same place for a more accurate direct comparison.

I love using pictures to keep track of fat loss because they give you a great reality check, positive or negative. Pictures also help keep you highly motivated to continue your program.

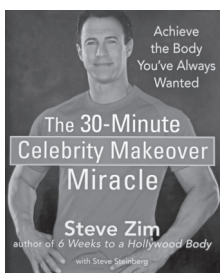
You can find great workouts in my previously published books. These titles include:



HOT POINT FITNESS

Publisher: De Capo Press Inc., 2000

My bestselling book, *Hot Point Fitness* is like having me training you at the gym. The book includes 3-, 4- and 5-day-a-week programs. This book also tells you how to choose which program is right for you. I include a progression for each workout for a full month to help you keep going. The book includes pictures and detailed descriptions of how to do all the exercises. This book is specifically for the gym — not home use. I believe this is one of the best fitness books ever written for the gym.



6 WEEKS TO A HOLLYWOOD BODY

Publisher: Wiley & Sons, 2006

This book is like having me train you at your home. You do not need to belong to a gym. This is a 3-day-a-week workout program that provides you with a regimen like those of the stars I train so that you can have a Hollywood body of your own. Unlike other books, this one provides programs based on your body type, whether you're an ectomorph, an endomorph, or a mesomorph — or a combination of two. I created specific training programs to suit each body type. I teach you how to figure out which type you are, and I give you the programs to follow.



THE 30-MINUTE CELEBRITY MAKEOVER MIRACLE

Publisher: Wiley & Sons, 2007

This book is a 30-minute-a-day, three-times-a-week, combined cardio and weight-training program. It will help you ramp up your metabolic rate, burn fat faster than conventional workouts, and produce changes in your overall appearance. Every time you exercise you'll perform a different workout focused on balancing your body.

Cardio—Choose What Works for You

You should perform whatever type you like to do best. Here's a list of choices. You can perform these for 30-75 minutes per session. Keep in mind that including more intense sequences and then scaling back helps burn bodyfat more efficiently. Take a look at my more specific recommendations, based on your needs. First, here are some great types of cardio you can choose.

Running

Walking

Jumping rope

Stair climber

Elliptical

Bike

Recumbent bike

Rowing

Boxing

Hula-hoop

Swimming

And many others I have not listed.

MY CARDIO SUGGESTIONS

The best results and the least amount of injuries come from a modified interval program. Pick an amount of cardio that is right for you. If you're a beginner start slow. Beginners can walk 5 to 10 minutes to begin with; everyone needs to start somewhere. Your starting point is what it is, but what I'm more concerned with is where you are going.

If your bodyfat is where you want it to be, then do no more than 30 minutes of cardio four times a week. If you need to reduce bodyfat by 10% or more (from 32% to 22%, for example), then do no less than four days a week of a minimum of 30 minutes of cardio. Anyone needing to lose over 10% bodyfat or more should do at least five days of cardio for no less than 30 minutes a day. Everyone can do cardio if they like seven days a week but nobody should do more than 75 min of cardio a day.

Here is my cardio prescription for everyone once they feel ready and able to do at least 30 minutes of continuous walking. Go slow for one minute then sprint or go all out for 15-30 seconds. Repeat this interval for your allotted amount of cardio time. The idea is you are constantly driving your heart rate up then dropping it. In terms of weight loss, my intervals are more effective than long, slow endurance exercise, and they're also easier on your body long-term.

The intense effort you put in means that your body must work harder to recover, so you'll burn more calories in the 24 hours after an interval workout than you would after a slow, steady run. During those 24 hours after high-intensity interval training (known as HIIT), your body can also produce up to 450% more human growth hormone, which also increases caloric burn and supports muscle growth.

Studies have shown that interval cardio accelerates your heart rate, but actually decreases the strain on your heart. Over time, cardiovascular exercise can increase your heart stroke volume, or the amount of blood that your heart pumps per beat. Interval training maximizes cardiovascular benefits, so it can quickly increase stroke volume, making your heart stronger and more efficient.

I could go on and on, but the bottom line is it will get you leaner at 100 miles an hour faster than regular cardio.

KEEP TRACK OF YOUR PROGRESS

Whether you record your information in this book, download it from my website at www.atighteru.com or keep track of it somewhere else, these are the most important measurements and numbers you should keep track of to make certain your program is working. Record all of these before you start following my program, and then take them again each week before you workout.

MEASUREMENTS

	DATE	DATE	DATE	DATE	DATE	DATE	DATE
Bodyfat%	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Scale weight (pounds)	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Fat (pounds)	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Muscle	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

Here's how you calculate your muscle mass, also known as lean body mass (which is composed of muscle, bone, tissue, water, and organs). It's everything except the fat below your skin.

Step 1) Subtract your bodyfat percentage from 100 to get your percent of lean mass

$$100 - \text{Bodyfat \%} = \text{Lean Mass \%}$$

Step 2) Turn that into a decimal by dividing by 100

$$\frac{\text{Lean Mass \%}}{100} = \text{Lean Mass \% as a decimal}$$

Step 3) Multiply your lean mass decimal by your total bodyweight to get your muscle mass in pounds

$$\text{Lean Mass \% decimal point} \times \text{Total bodyweight} = \text{Lean Mass weight decimal point}$$

Here is an example using a 200-lb person with 20% bodyfat:

$100 - 20 = 80$
 $80 / 100 = 0.80$
 $0.80 \times 200 = 160$ (Lean Mass) and 40 pounds of bodyfat

Next, insert your measurements using a tape measure below. Make sure to take the measurements at the same place every time. Be sure to measure both sides.

DATE	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Neck	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Shoulders	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Chest	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Waist	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Hips	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
	RT/LT	RT/LT	RT/LT	RT/LT	RT/LT	RT/LT	RT/LT
Thighs	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Calf	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Biceps	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

Now let's take the information above one step further and figure out how many pounds of fat you have vs. how many pounds of lean body mass you have. This is very important because, as I told you earlier, many nutrition programs may make your bodyweight go down at the cost of losing lean muscle. Remember, the goal of my program is to increase lean muscle, while decreasing bodyfat. If you decrease both, you will never be able to hold onto the progress with the new body you have achieved.

Here is an example of how to calculate the amount of bodyfat you have and the amount of muscle you have.

EXAMPLE CALCULATION: This is for a person who weighs 150 pounds with 25% bodyfat, typical for many women.

$$\begin{array}{rcll} \text{Step 1)} & 100\% & - & 25\% & = & 75\% \\ & & & \text{(Bodyfat Percentage)} & & \text{(Lean Mass Percentage)} \end{array}$$

$$\text{Step 2)} \quad 75 / 100 = .75$$

$$\text{Step 3)} \quad .75 \times 150 = 112.5$$

So this person has 112.5 lb of lean mass at the start of the process and 37.5 lb of bodyfat.

This person's start point is:

Bodyweight: 150 lb

Lean Body Mass: 112.5 lb

Amount of Fat: 37.5 lb

Now lets say this person takes their calipers measurements two weeks later. This woman weighs 148 lb, but her bodyfat is now at 23%.

$$\text{Step 1)} \quad 100\% - 23\% = 77\%$$

So her lean mass has gone up to two percentage points.

$$\text{Step 2)} \quad 77 / 100 = .77$$

$$\text{Step 3)} \quad .77 \times 148 = \text{about } 114 \text{ lb}$$

So this person's new numbers are:

Bodyweight: 148 lb

Lean Body Mass: 114 lb

Amount of bodyfat: 34 lb

That's nearly a 10% reduction in bodyfat while the scale weight has only shifted two pounds!

NOW, IT'S TIME FOR YOUR CALCULATIONS DAY 1:

Take your measurements and fill in this chart to determine where you are at the starting point of your program.

Step 1) $100\% - \underline{\hspace{2cm}} = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$
(your percentage of bodyfat) (your lean mass %)

Step 2) $\underline{\hspace{2cm}} / 100 = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$
(your lean mass %) (your lean mass as a decimal)

Step 3) $\underline{\hspace{2cm}} \times \underline{\hspace{2cm}} = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$
(your current weight) (your lean mass as a decimal) (your lean mass in pounds)

Your start point is:

Bodyweight: $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ lb

Lean Body Mass: $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ lb

Amount of bodyfat: $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ lb

MAKE NEW CALCULATIONS ONCE A WEEK:

Perform this seven days after your start point. Then continue to record this data every week. Choose a day or the week where you can get a calipers test to continue to monitor your progress at regular intervals. Note that it's important to have the same person perform the calipers test as that's more accurate (in terms of your progress) than using different people for this test.

Step 1) $100\% - \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your percentage of bodyfat)}} = \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass \%)}}$

Step 2) $\frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass \%)}} / 100 = \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass as a decimal)}}$

Step 3) $\frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your current weight)}} \times \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass as a decimal)}} = \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass in pounds)}}$

Your start point is:

Bodyweight: _____ lb

Lean Body Mass: _____ lb

Amount of bodyfat: _____ lb

YOUR WEEK 3 CALCULATIONS:

Step 1) $100\% - \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your percentage of bodyfat)}} = \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass \%)}}$

Step 2) $\frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass \%)}} / 100 = \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass as a decimal)}}$

Step 3) $\frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your current weight)}} \times \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass as a decimal)}} = \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass in pounds)}}$

Your start point is:

Bodyweight: _____ lb

Lean Body Mass: _____ lb

Amount of bodyfat: _____ lb

YOUR WEEK 4 CALCULATIONS:

Step 1) $100\% - \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your percentage of bodyfat)}} = \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass \%)}}$

Step 2) $\frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass \%)}} / 100 = \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass as a decimal)}}$

Step 3) $\frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your current weight)}} \times \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass as a decimal)}} = \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass in pounds)}}$

Your start point is:

Bodyweight: _____ lb

Lean Body Mass: _____ lb

Amount of bodyfat: _____ lb

YOUR WEEK 5 CALCULATIONS:

Step 1) $100\% - \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your percentage of bodyfat)}} = \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass \%)}}$

Step 2) $\frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass \%)}} / 100 = \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass as a decimal)}}$

Step 3) $\frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your current weight)}} \times \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass as a decimal)}} = \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass in pounds)}}$

Your start point is:

Bodyweight: _____ lb

Lean Body Mass: _____ lb

Amount of bodyfat: _____ lb

YOUR WEEK 6 CALCULATIONS:

Step 1) $100\% - \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your percentage of bodyfat)}} = \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass \%)}}$

Step 2) $\frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass \%)}} / 100 = \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass as a decimal)}}$

Step 3) $\frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your current weight)}} \times \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass as a decimal)}} = \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass in pounds)}}$

Your start point is:

Bodyweight: _____ lb

Lean Body Mass: _____ lb

Amount of bodyfat: _____ lb

YOUR WEEK 7 CALCULATIONS:

Step 1) $100\% - \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your percentage of bodyfat)}} = \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass \%)}}$

Step 2) $\frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass \%)}} / 100 = \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass as a decimal)}}$

Step 3) $\frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your current weight)}} \times \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass as a decimal)}} = \frac{\text{_____}}{\text{(your lean mass in pounds)}}$

Your start point is:

Bodyweight: _____ lb

Lean Body Mass: _____ lb

Amount of bodyfat: _____ lb



USE A SKIN-CALIPER TEST

These numbers are very important. You need to know that you are not losing muscle while you are losing fat. It's crucial when you do this that you have an accurate reading of your bodyfat or your numbers will be off. Many people use cheap bodyfat measurements that are inaccurate. I suggest a professional skin-caliper test because it's the easiest and least expensive way to get an accurate reading.

If you have the money and access, you can also get a hydrostatic bodyfat test, which provides an extremely accurate measure of bodyfat. But the latter isn't necessary unless you want to be hyper-vigilant. A skin-caliper test is nearly as accurate, far simpler and a great option to get you started.

You should also take pictures of yourself, as I mentioned before. This is so you can also see your physical changes over time. It's important to understand that we do not choose where our bodies remove fat from first. Many times people will lose bodyfat and all of a sudden they see love handles they never saw before. They freak out and think this whole body-changing resolution is going terribly wrong and then they quit. This is why tracking your measurements is incredibly important. Retake your abdominal and other measurements each week and see how they've changed from the previous measurement. They may or may not be smaller, but at least you'll know.

Often, people lose bodyfat around their torso more quickly than the fat

SUPERHERO STORY: Fat Loss Has No Pattern

★ In the video "22% of bodyfat in 6 weeks," one of the women, Claire, was losing a lot of bodyfat around her torso and for several days she felt as though she was looking funny and was really confused. So I explained to her that the areas that are lagging behind will pick up the pace quickly once the easy-to-lose areas are done losing all of their fat. Sure enough with another week the tough-to-lose places started to get smaller and then she relaxed into the process.

It's hard to wrap your brain around the idea that you don't lose fat evenly and it has a pattern all its own. Every person will not lose fat the same way, but in the end, if you follow this program, you will get the results you're seeking.

in their lower abdominal area. You may see a temporary period where this imbalance is noticeable to you more than anyone else. Keep working hard and stick to your plan. As certain areas of your body run out of fat to lose then your body will quickly attack your hard-to-lose areas. When you start attacking those hard-to-lose areas, you will start to see your body change almost daily. It's really empowering when you see yourself changing, because you realize that all your work is being realized.

SUPERHERO STORY: Bodyfat Perspective

🌟 Below is a list of common bodyfat percentages of college student athletes from various sports.* It's important to understand that your goal is to lose bodyfat, not to get to a certain "idealized" goal. Note how much bodyfat percentages vary for many very successful athletes.

	MALE	FEMALE
Sprinting	8-10%	12-20%
Soccer	10-18%	13-18%
Swimmers	9-12%	14-24%
Tennis	12-16%	16-24%
Gymnastics	5-12%	10-16%
Distance running	5-11%	10-15%
Volleyball	11-14%	16-25%
Tennis	12-16%	16-25%
Shot Put	16-20%	20-28%
Ice/Field hockey	8-15%	12-18%
High/long jumpers	7-12%	10-18%
Baseball	12-15%	12-18%
Basketball	6-12%	20-27%
Football (backs)	9-12%	no data
Football (lineman)	15-19%	no data
Wrestling	5-16%	no data

** Moon J, Tobkin S, Smith A, Lockwood C, Walter A, Cramer J, Beck T, Stout J, "Anthropometric Estimates of Percent Bodyfat in NCAA Division I Female Athletes: A 4-Compartment Model Validation" J Str, Cond Res. 2009:23 (4) 1069-79*

DON'T FEAR SUCCESS

I need to explain a phenomenon that over the 25-plus years I have trained I have seen play out time and time again. I call it “fear of success.” This is a real phenomenon that is more difficult to deal with for many people than failure. If this is the first time you are seeing yourself achieve success in your body-transformation goal, then you are entering uncharted territory.

For instance, sometimes a compliment can backfire and send you longing for the place you were used to instead of being comfortable with your new body. If you believe you're starting to sabotage your progress, stop and regroup. Gather yourself and make a conscious effort to stop the sabotaging behavior. For example, you start to hit the candy jar you used to walk by, or you snack during the day. Or you begin to skip workouts and go out to eat instead.

Refocus and realize this journey is for you and no one else. Your fitness journey is the one of the few things in your life you can actually control. You can't control the economy, politics or what's going on in the world, but you can control what you put in your mouth and how much exercise you perform.

Below are a few suggestions I share with my clients to get them to stay on track throughout this transformation and beyond.

- 1) **Be positive.** Start every day before you get out of bed with a positive, one-line mantra such as: “I'm going to have a great day today!” Then smile. Don't underestimate this—it really helps start your day on a positive note.
- 2) **Realize you'll become an inspiration.** Remind yourself that your success will motivate others.
- 3) **Own your progress.** If you feel like you're going off track, then try saying something like, “Why not me?” Meaning why can't I be one of those people who is successful and reaches my goals? The beauty is that you are 100% in charge of you, and there will be nobody to thank or blame but you. Recall the enthusiasm you began this journey with and keep it going as you continue.

I believe that success breeds success. There are few things harder to do in life than to lose fat and keep it off. When you are in control of your body you should feel very confident and that shines from you in every interaction you have. People are always attracted to confidence, and it will open up unexpected doors at work and in your social life.

